

4G to cover half the world by 2017

Though Airtel is currently the only telecom provider in India to offer 4G mobile network in Kolkata and Bengaluru, 4G network will cover half the world by 2017—according to Ericsson's annual report. This would mean that high-speed Internet access would be a common phenomenon, making it easy to download videos and play games on the go.

"This revolution is driven by smartphones, video, cloud-based services, the Internet and end-to-end connectivity," said Johan Wiberg, head of Ericsson's networks unit after the release of the report.

According to the report, data traffic, particularly video, is expected to grow 15-fold by 2017. While 3G will remain the main technology for years to come, the demand for high-speed Internet access means operators will have to build new 4G networks to cope.

LG, Samsung dominate tablet display panel market

Display makers LG Display and Samsung Display in 2011 remained the top suppliers of panels to the market for tablet devices, accounting for more than 80 per cent of all shipments.

Of the 81.3 million panels shipped to the tablet space in 2011, LG Display controlled the largest portion of the market at 46 per cent, followed by Samsung at 35 per cent, according to an IHS iSuppli report.

Between them, the two South Korean electronics garnered a whopping 81 per cent of the entire tablet panel market in 2011. While this was down from the 98 per cent combined share they commanded in 2010, the companies maintained a dominant portion of the market in 2011.

Samsung gets new CEO

As Samsung battles Apple for supremacy in smartphones, the South Korean company has appointed Kwon Oh-hyun as the new CEO. Kwon, currently head of Samsung's components business, has been tasked

with handling corporate-wide affairs as the company's new CEO. He will also continue at the helm of the company's components business.

On the other hand, CEO Choi Gee-sung is moving to a new role as head of Samsung Group's corporate strategy.

The remainder of the market was split among six suppliers: Chimei Innotek, Chunghwa Picture Tubes and E-Ink Holdings, all from Taiwan; Tianma Microelectronics Co. and Beijing Orient Electronics Group from China; and Hitachi Displays from Japan.

Microsoft set to become the second largest tablet maker

Microsoft as the second largest tablet manufacturer is in the making, posing serious threat to the Android market. Computex 2012 trade show held recently in Taiwan witnessed the Windows 8 fever and

now it seems that the much talked about Windows 8 tablets are going to prelude the era of tablets cum Ultrabooks with their keyboard dock and touch functionality. Seeing the productivity superiority of Windows, there is no doubt that Android and iOS will face a fierce competition in the near future.

Analyst Karthryn Huberty of Morgan Stanley has predicted that Microsoft will soon take the No. 2 spot after Apple iPad in the tablet market, outdoing Android. Their survey suggests 25 per cent of users expect to buy Windows 8 tablet and Office is a key feature, especially for those considering their first tablet purchase. The software giant should be able to attract tablet builders by bundling its two strongest personal computer brands—Office and Windows.

Windows 8 running tablets including ASUS Taichi, Acer W510, MSI Slider S20, Acer Iconia W700 and the ASUS Transformer Book are expected to hit the market later this year.

Just 4.5 per cent of India's e-waste gets recycled

Less than five per cent of India's total electronic waste (e-waste) gets recycled due to absence of proper infrastructure, legislation and framework for disposing of electronic gadgets and products



Acer Iconia W700 tablet running Windows 8